



Gritty performance: Anupriya V. S. created a new meet record in girls shot put with a mark of 17.22.

B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Aiming for the stars: In javelin throw, Deepika threw a distance of 56.79m to clinch the gold, breaking her previous meet record in the process. M. VEDHAN

India for the winners and deserving sportspersons. Apart from its numerous schemes, SDAT gives ₹2 lakh, ₹1.50 lakh and ₹1 lakh to the gold, silver and bronze medal winners of KIYG, respectively.

KIYG also awards ₹10,000 per month for three years for sportspersons selected by the KIYG selection committee.

Boxer V. Devarajan, former World Cup medallist and Olympian, said that the boxing venue for KIYG at the Tamil Nadu Physical & Sports University (TNPESU) was world class. "I felt I was walking into an international venue," he told *Sportstar*.

The 50-year-old said that since TNPESU was situated outside Chennai (Kancheepuram district) players and officials had to travel quite a distance to reach the venue, which was indeed a bit taxing for them. "They had to travel 30 kms from their rooms to the venue. Food was a problem initially and there were quite a few other issues too, but

slowly the organisers worked on the shortcomings to conduct a wonderful event," he said.

Devarajan said that the Boxing Federation of India and Sports Authority of India should hold talent hunts in TN, Andhra and other South Indian cities like the one they organised in Bengaluru. At various venues of the Games, there wasn't any big response from the public. But for the volleyball final at the Nehru Indoor Stadium, when eventual champion TN clashed with Haryana, a sizeable crowd really enjoyed the match.

S. Dakshinamoorthy, the volleyball coach of SRM University and a veteran talent spotter, said that SAI is doing an excellent job in spotting talent and rewarding them. Even though SAI does routine assessments on the players after picking them, Dakshinamoorthy said an exposure trip for the selected players will do a world of good to their morale.

"KIYG is a turning point for many

